QUANTUM QUORUM · PHYSICS SOCIETY, GTBIT

Q-VERSE '26

Technical Physics Research & Innovation Challenge

PARTICIPANT GUIDELINES & STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

About Q-VERSE

Q-VERSE '26 is an inter-college technical research and innovation challenge organised by Quantum Quorum — Physics Society, GTBIT. It gives students a structured pathway to take an original idea, develop it into a complete research paper with mentorship, and present it before a judging panel.

Open to students of all years, across all colleges, individually or in teams.

How Q-VERSE Works

01	IDEA — Submit your research abstract.
02	SHORTLIST — Selected abstracts move forward.
03	MENTOR — Refine your idea with guidance.
04	RESEARCH — Develop the idea into a complete paper.
05	SUBMIT — Paper + Similarity Report + AI Report + PPT.
06	PRESENT — Present on stage and face the Q&A.
07	RECOGNITION — Best research and presentations are awarded.

1. Eligibility

- Open to students of all years (1st year onwards) from any college or university.
- Inter-college participation is allowed — team members do not need to be from the same institution.
- Participants may take part individually or in teams of up to 5 members.
- Only currently enrolled students may be listed as authors or co-authors.
- Faculty members, mentors, or guides may be acknowledged in the paper but cannot be listed as co-authors.
- At least one author must be present for the final presentation, and the presenting author must be an eligible student.

2. Research Themes

Every submission must be made under exactly one of the five themes below. A team should select the single theme that best represents its primary research focus — genuinely cross-disciplinary work should be submitted under Theme 5 rather than split across themes.

#	Theme	Scope
1	Science, Technology & Innovation	Innovative solutions, experimental concepts, emerging technologies, scientific research, and technical applications.
2	AI, Data Science & Automation	Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, data analysis, robotics, IoT, automation, computational techniques, and their applications.
3	Energy, Environment & Sustainability	Climate change, sustainable technologies, resource management, renewable energy, energy efficiency, and environmental challenges.
4	Engineering, Materials & Emerging Technologies	Engineering applications, nanotechnology, advanced materials, electronics, biomedical technologies, and emerging technological systems.
5	Interdisciplinary Research	Research combining two or more disciplines, including Physics, Computer Science, Mathematics, Biology, Chemistry, Engineering, Medicine, Economics, Social Sciences, and other fields.

3. Event Timeline

Q-VERSE runs across three stages. Exact dates will be announced by the organising committee through official channels; the sequence and structure below are fixed.

Stage	Milestone	What Happens	Date
Stage 1	Registration & Abstract Submission	Teams register and submit a research abstract under one theme.	To be announced
Stage 1	Shortlisting	Abstracts are screened; shortlisted teams are notified.	To be announced
Stage 2	Mentorship & Research Development	Shortlisted teams receive guidance and develop the full research paper.	To be announced
Stage 2	Final Submission	Research paper, Similarity Report, AI Detection Report, and Presentation (PPT) are due.	To be announced
Stage 3	Final Presentation & Q&A	Shortlisted papers are presented before the judging panel.	To be announced
Stage 3	Results & Recognition	Winners are announced and certificates issued.	To be announced

4. Abstract Template

Word limit: 500–800 words.

The abstract must state what you are investigating and how you intend to investigate it — not a general description of the topic area.

✘ Avoid: *"Artificial Intelligence is becoming increasingly important in today's world."*
✔ Better: *"This study investigates whether machine-learning models can improve short-term solar power generation forecasting using historical weather and generation data."*

Required Sections

- Title of the Research
- Author(s) and Selected Theme
- Background / Research Problem
- Objective / Research Question
- Methodology / Approach
- Key Expected Findings or Contribution
- Keywords

5. Research Paper Template

What Counts as a Research Paper

Submissions must demonstrate the participants' own analysis, interpretation, methodology, or findings. Acceptable approaches include an original analysis of existing data, a computational or numerical investigation, an experiment, a comparative study, a model or simulation, or a critical/systematic review built around an original research perspective.

> Not accepted: a descriptive or textbook-style summary of an existing topic, or a broad literature review with no original synthesis or perspective, does not qualify as a research paper.

Standard Structure

Not every heading is mandatory for every paper — a theoretical paper may not need a Data/Experimental Setup section — but the overall structure should follow this order, and the paper must show a clear progression from problem to methodology, analysis, findings, and conclusion.

- Title
- Author(s) & Affiliations
- Abstract
- Keywords
- Introduction
- Literature Review / Background
- Research Problem & Objectives
- Methodology
- Data / Experimental Setup (where applicable)
- Results & Analysis
- Discussion
- Conclusion
- Future Scope
- References

Formatting Specification

Element	Requirement
File format	PDF
Language	English
Font	Times New Roman
Body text size	12 pt
Line spacing	1.5
Page size	A4
Margins	1 inch, all sides
Alignment	Justified
Word limit	3,000–5,000 words (flexibility for highly technical/computational papers)
Citation style	APA 7th Edition — required for all in-text citations and the reference list

Figures, Tables & Supporting Material

Research papers must use appropriate graphs, tables, figures, flowcharts, diagrams, equations, photographs, simulation outputs, or other supporting visual/analytical material wherever relevant to the research.

- Every figure and table must carry a clear number and caption.
- Material drawn from external sources must be properly cited in-text and listed in the references.
- Participants should prioritise original figures, self-generated graphs, or openly licensed material.

6. Final Deliverables

Shortlisted teams must submit all four items below by the final deadline. The Research Paper is the document judges evaluate; the Presentation is a separate, shorter deck used only on stage.

#	Deliverable	Format	Purpose
1	Final Research Paper	PDF, formatted per Section 5	Submitted to the judging panel for evaluation
2	Similarity / Plagiarism Report	Software-generated (see Section 7)	Proves originality against published and web sources
3	AI Detection Report	Software-generated, 0% AI-generated content	Required under the event's AI policy (see Section 7)
4	Presentation (PPT/PDF)	Maximum 12 slides	Used only for the live stage presentation and Q&A

7. Plagiarism & AI Policy

Originality Policy

All submissions must be the participants' own original work. The following are strictly prohibited:

- Copying content from published papers, websites, or other submissions without attribution
- Submitting another person's research as one's own
- Reusing previously submitted or published work without disclosure
- Fabricating or manipulating research data
- Using false, fabricated, or unverifiable references
- Misrepresenting the source of information, figures, images, or datasets

Similarity Report — Required, Software-Generated

A self-declaration of originality is not sufficient. Every final submission must include a similarity report generated by a recognised plagiarism-detection tool.

Status	Tool	Note
Preferred	Turnitin Similarity Report	Where accessible through a participating institution's existing license.
Accepted alternative	Copyleaks or Quetext	Since Turnitin licenses are institution-only and not sold to individual students, these individually accessible tools are accepted equivalents.

Similarity threshold: below 10% overall, excluding the bibliography/reference list and unavoidable standard phrases. Papers exceeding this threshold will not proceed to the presentation round.

AI Detection Report — Required, Software-Generated

The event requires 0% AI-generated content. This must be demonstrated through a report from a recognised AI-detection tool, not a written declaration.

Status	Tool	Note
Preferred / accepted	GPTZero or Copyleaks AI Detector	Both are individually accessible (no institutional license required) and widely used for academic AI-writing detection.

Note on accuracy: AI-detection tools provide a probabilistic estimate, not a definitive verdict. The organising committee will weigh the AI report together with the Q&A round when assessing originality, rather than treating the percentage alone as absolute proof.

AI Usage Rule

Generative AI tools must not be used to generate or substantially write the submitted abstract, research paper, analysis, conclusions, figures, or any other substantive academic content. This is a single, unambiguous rule with no exceptions — including for grammar or language correction. Participants remain fully responsible for the originality, accuracy, citations, and integrity of their submitted work.

AI must also not be used to fabricate references, generate research findings, or manipulate data.

8. Presentation Guidelines

The Presentation is a separate, shorter deck for the stage round — distinct from the Research Paper submitted to judges.

- Format: PPT or PDF, maximum 12 slides.
- Duration: 8–10 minutes presentation, followed by 3–5 minutes of Q&A (strictly enforced).
- Graphs, diagrams, and visuals must be clear and legible from a distance.

The Presentation Must Cover

- Research problem and motivation
- Objectives
- Methodology
- Results / analysis
- Key findings
- Conclusion
- Future scope

Q&A May Cover

- The research problem and its significance
- Methodology and choice of approach
- Data or sources used
- Results and their interpretation
- Limitations of the study
- Original contribution of the work
- Future scope

9. Judging & Evaluation

Criteria	Weightage
Originality & Innovation	20%
Research Problem & Objectives	15%
Methodology & Research Approach	20%
Analysis, Results & Interpretation	20%
Presentation & Visual Communication	10%
Q&A / Subject Understanding	15%
Total	100%

The decision of the judging panel regarding shortlisting, scores, and awards is final.

10. Disqualification Criteria

A submission may be disqualified for any of the following:

- Plagiarism or academic misconduct
- Failure to meet the prescribed similarity or AI-detection requirements
- Fabrication or manipulation of data
- False or unverifiable citations and references
- Late submission without prior approval from the organising committee
- Major deviation from the approved abstract's topic without committee approval
- Violation of authorship rules (e.g. faculty listed as co-author, ghost or honorary authorship)
- Submitting work already published or presented elsewhere without disclosure
- Failure to submit all required deliverables
- Misconduct during the presentation or at the event

11. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can first-year students participate? A: Yes. Q-VERSE is open to students of all years, from 1st year onwards.
Q: Can our team include students from different colleges? A: Yes, Q-VERSE is an inter-college event — team members do not need to belong to the same institution.
Q: Can we change our research topic after being shortlisted? A: Minor refinements are expected during mentorship. A major change in topic or direction requires prior approval from the organising committee.
Q: Is a review paper allowed? A: Only a critical or systematic review built around an original research perspective. A general, textbook-style summary of existing literature will not be accepted.
Q: Can we submit an existing college project? A: Only if the research presented is substantially the participants' own original work and has not been previously submitted or presented as the same work elsewhere.
Q: Who can be listed as a co-author? A: Only student team members who made a meaningful contribution to the research. Faculty members or mentors may be acknowledged but cannot be listed as co-authors.
Q: What happens if our similarity or AI report doesn't meet the threshold? A: The submission will not proceed to the presentation round. Teams are strongly encouraged to run their own check well before the deadline.
Q: What if something isn't covered in this document? A: The organising committee's decision on any matter not explicitly covered here is final.